HEALTH AND SAFETY MANUAL

Straight Arrow Traffic Control Inc.

Built to Go Home.

Version 1.2 | Effective October 1, 2026 | Revised October 15, 2026

Issued by Corporate Safety | Approved by the Chief Executive Officer

This manual is issued by and speaks only for Straight Arrow Traffic Control Inc..

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Straight Arrow Traffic Control Inc.

CHAPTER 1. POLICY STATEMENT AND SCOPE

The signature block and entity variables are completed at issuance at assembly.

1.1 Safety Policy

It is the policy of Straight Arrow Traffic Control Inc. that every person on our work goes home in the same condition they arrived. No schedule, no client demand, and no dollar amount changes that. Safe work is a condition of employment at every level of this company, and it is a condition of leadership: managers and supervisors are accountable for the safety of the people they direct.

The Company commits to the following:

- Provide the equipment, training, planning time, and staffing that safe work requires.
- Identify hazards before work begins and control them before anyone is exposed.
- Comply with every applicable safety and health regulation, and go beyond compliance where our work demands it.
- Investigate every incident and near miss to fix the system, and hold people accountable under one standard, consistently applied.
- Back every employee who stops work over a safety concern. Without exception.

Every employee commits to work by this manual, follow the 7 Rules That Keep You Alive, plan their work, look out for the person next to them, and stop work when something is wrong.

_____

Kirby Hays, Chief Executive Officer Date

1.2 Scope

This manual applies to every employee of Straight Arrow Traffic Control Inc., on every jobsite, facility, yard, and vehicle, on every shift. It applies to temporary employees and to any person working under the Company's direction. Subcontractors are governed by their own programs and by Chapter 22 where this entity acts as a controlling contractor.

This manual is issued by and speaks only for Straight Arrow Traffic Control Inc.. It creates no obligations for, and makes no statements on behalf of, any other company.

1.3 Related Programs and Order of Precedence

This manual works alongside the Employee Handbook (Part VII, Health and Safety, and Section 8.5, Discipline), the Fleet Management Program, the Combined Drug and Alcohol Policy, the Workplace Violence Prevention Plan, and client site rules and contract safety exhibits. Where requirements differ between any of these documents, or between this manual and a regulation, the stricter requirement governs. Where a client rule is stricter than ours, we follow the client rule on that client's work. Where ours is stricter, ours applies everywhere.

Nothing in this manual creates a contract of employment or alters at-will employment.

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CHAPTER 2. SAFETY ORGANIZATION AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Named persons for this entity are listed in Appendix A so personnel changes never require a manual revision.

2.1 How Responsibility Runs

Safety responsibility follows the chain of command. It is never delegated away: assigning a duty to someone does not remove it from the person above them. The named-person table for this entity, including the IIPP Administrator, is in Appendix A. Competent person designations by discipline are kept in the training matrix maintained by Corporate Safety; anyone who needs to know who is competent person trained for a task contacts Corporate Safety.

2.2 Responsibilities by Role

Chief Executive Officer

- Owns this policy. Signs it, funds it, and holds leadership accountable to it.
- Sits on the review committee for Step 3 and Step 4 discipline actions (Chapter 5.7).

Vice President

- Accountable for implementation across operations. Resolves resource conflicts in favor of safe work.
- Sits on the review committee. Reviews the central safety log and program metrics with Corporate Safety.

Corporate Safety Officer

- IIPP Administrator. Maintains this manual, the module library, the central safety log, and the training matrix.
- Reviews every discipline action above Step 1 before issuance. Leads or oversees every incident investigation (Form 10A).
- Conducts unannounced site and facility inspections and tracks corrective actions to closure.

Entity Operations Leadership

- Builds safety into schedules, budgets, and manning. A plan that cannot be executed safely is not an approved plan.
- Consulted on job impact before committee decisions are final (Chapter 5.7).

Superintendents and Foremen

- Own safety on their sites and crews. Lead pre-task planning, run tailboards, conduct inspections, enforce the rules on the spot, and document coaching in the central log.
- A supervisor who observes a violation and does not act has committed a Tier 2 violation (Chapter 5.8).

Site Safety Officers (where assigned)

- Support the superintendent with inspections, orientations, monitoring, and documentation. Assignment of an SSO does not transfer the superintendent's responsibility.

Fleet Manager

- Authority for vehicle and DOT matters under the Fleet Management Program. Chapter 25 governs the interface.

Every Employee

- Work by this manual and the 7 Rules. Inspect your equipment. Plan your task. Wear your PPE.
- Report hazards, injuries, near misses, and damage the same shift. Stop work that is not safe.

2.3 Competent Persons

Work that requires a competent person under Title 8 (excavation, scaffolds, fall protection, and others per the entity's modules) is not performed until a designated competent person is on site with the authority to stop the work and correct the hazard. Designations are made in writing by Corporate Safety based on training and demonstrated experience, and are tracked in the training matrix maintained by Corporate Safety. Anyone who needs to confirm a designation contacts Corporate Safety. Holding a card does not make a person competent; the designation does.

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CHAPTER 3. INJURY AND ILLNESS PREVENTION PROGRAM

Anchored to Cal/OSHA (T8 CCR 3203).

3.1 Purpose

This chapter is the Injury and Illness Prevention Program required by Title 8, California Code of Regulations, Section 3203. It is the framework every other chapter hangs on: who is responsible, how hazards get found and fixed, how we communicate about safety, how incidents get investigated, and how training happens. If a question is not answered elsewhere in this manual, it is answered here.

3.2 Responsibility

The IIPP Administrator for Straight Arrow Traffic Control Inc. is the Corporate Safety Officer, Sergio Robles, with authority and responsibility for implementing and maintaining this program. Entity operations leadership, superintendents, and foremen implement it on every site, every shift. Every employee is responsible for working safely, following this manual, and reporting hazards. The named-person table for this entity, including the Administrator and designated competent persons, is in Appendix A.

3.3 Compliance

The system for ensuring employees comply with safe work practices is Chapter 5, Enforcement and Accountability: one standard, three tiers, four steps, applied identically to everyone. Compliance is also recognized: supervisors and Corporate Safety acknowledge crews and individuals who work safely, surface hazards, and stop work when conditions call for it. Safe work is a condition of employment.

3.4 Communication

Safety communication runs in both directions, in a form readily understandable by all affected employees, including Spanish where crews require it:

- Daily pre-task planning and tailboard meetings on every crew (Chapter 7).
- Toolbox talks at least weekly, documented with topic and attendance.
- Safety alerts issued by Corporate Safety after significant incidents, near misses, or regulatory changes.
- New-hire orientation and the condensed field handbook (Chapter 23).

- Direct access: any employee may raise any safety concern to any supervisor, Corporate Safety, or Human Resources, in any language, at any time.
- Anonymous reporting: employees may report hazards anonymously to Corporate Safety, by phone or through the posted safety QR code, which links to a report form that can be submitted anonymously and is delivered directly to Corporate Safety. No employee will be retaliated against for reporting a hazard or an injury, anonymously or by name (Chapter 5.3).

3.5 Hazard Identification and Periodic Inspections

Hazards are found on a schedule and whenever conditions change, not only after something goes wrong.

- Daily: the crew inspects the work area, tools, and equipment as part of pre-task planning. Equipment operators complete the daily equipment checklist before operation.
- Weekly: the superintendent or foreman conducts and documents a site inspection on the standard checklist.
- Monthly: yards, shops, and facilities are inspected on the facility checklist by the responsible manager.
- Periodic and unannounced: Corporate Safety inspects sites and facilities across the entity, prioritized by risk and incident history.
- Event-driven: inspections are performed whenever new substances, processes, equipment, or procedures are introduced, whenever a new or previously unrecognized hazard is reported, and after any incident or near miss.

Inspection records identify the site, the date, the inspector, the hazards found, and the correction status, and are retained per Chapter 9.

3.6 Incident Investigation

Every occupational injury, illness, near miss, and property or utility damage event is investigated under Chapter 8 on Form 10A. The investigation identifies what happened, why the system allowed it, and what will prevent it, and its corrective actions are tracked to closure in the central safety log.

3.7 Hazard Correction

Hazards are corrected when found. Where correction takes time, interim protection is put in place immediately.

- Imminent hazard: work in the affected area stops now. Exposed employees are removed, and only employees necessary to correct the condition, with proper protection, may enter. Work does not resume until the hazard is corrected.
- Serious hazard: corrected before the affected work continues, and no later than the same shift.
- Other hazards: corrected on a documented schedule with a named owner, tracked to closure in the central safety log.

3.8 Training and Instruction

Training is provided when the program is first established, to every new employee at orientation, to every employee given a new job assignment for which training has not been received, whenever new substances, processes, procedures, or equipment introduce a new hazard, whenever the Company is made aware of a new or previously unrecognized hazard, and to supervisors on the hazards of the work they direct. The role-based training matrix, refresher cadences, and verification requirements are in Chapter 23. Training assigned as a condition of work is paid time.

3.9 Records

IIPP records, including inspection records and training documentation, are maintained per Chapter 9. Inspection records are retained at least one year; training records at least three years, or longer where a specific standard requires it.

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CHAPTER 4. CODE OF SAFE PRACTICES

Posted at each jobsite, or readily available with a posted notice of its location, per T8 1509. It is entity-specific and speaks only in Straight Arrow Traffic Control Inc.'s name.

CHAPTER 5. ENFORCEMENT AND ACCOUNTABILITY

Entity manuals are generated from this master; do not edit entity copies directly.

5.1 Purpose and Principle

This chapter sets one standard for safety accountability. The same rules, the same tiers, and the same consequences apply to every employee of Straight Arrow Traffic Control Inc., from a first-day laborer to the most senior superintendent, in every division and on every jobsite. Discipline under this chapter is corrective before it is punitive: the goal is that everyone goes home, every day. The Company distinguishes honest mistakes from risky drift and from conscious disregard, and it responds to each differently. What it does not do is look the other way.

This chapter works together with the Employee Handbook (Part VII, Health and Safety, and Section 8.5, Discipline). Nothing in this chapter creates a contract of employment or alters at-will employment. The Company retains discretion under Handbook Section 8.5 to apply the level of corrective action appropriate to the facts and circumstances of each case.

5.2 The 7 Rules That Keep You Alive

Seven rules cover the hazards most likely to kill or seriously injure. They are posted at every jobsite and facility, issued on a wallet card to every field employee, and signed for at orientation.

1. Lock it. Tag it. Try it.

Verify zero energy and apply your own lock and tag before working on any energized system.

2. Tie off above 6 feet. Every time.

Ladders, scaffolds, lifts, and roofs included. Anchor points rated for 5,000 pounds.

3. Know your line of fire.

Never under a suspended load, never in a swing radius, never between moving equipment and a fixed object.

4. No trench entry without protection.

Five feet or deeper requires a competent person inspection, protective systems, and egress within 25 feet.

5. Live track and live traffic kill.

No one fouls a track or steps into a traffic lane until on-track safety or traffic control is established and the briefing is complete.

6. Seatbelts on. Spotter when backing. Phone down.

Every vehicle, every piece of mobile equipment, every shift. A spotter is required whenever backing or offloading where any person could be in the path or where vision is limited. Working alone, a documented walk-around immediately before the move is the accepted alternative.

7. Show up ready to work.

Free of impairment from drugs, alcohol, or fatigue. Disclose any medication that affects alertness before your shift.

5.3 Stop Work Authority and Anti-Retaliation

Every employee has the authority and the obligation to stop any work they reasonably believe is unsafe. Work does not resume until the condition is corrected and the person who stopped the work, or a supervisor, confirms it is safe to proceed. No employee will ever be disciplined, demoted, reassigned, or treated worse for stopping work in good faith, reporting a hazard, reporting an injury, or refusing unsafe work. Retaliation against an employee who exercises stop work authority or reports in good faith is itself a Tier 1 violation and grounds for termination of the retaliating employee, including supervisors.

5.4 The Three Violation Tiers

Tier	Definition	Examples	Entry Point
Tier 1. Life-Critical	Conduct that could kill or seriously injure. Violations of the 7 Rules.	Untied at heights; LOTO bypass; line-of-fire violation; unprotected trench entry; fouling live track or traffic without protection; removing or disabling a safety device; working impaired.	Enters at Step 3. Reckless conduct enters at Step 4.
Tier 2. Major Operational	Serious failure of judgment, process, or care that creates significant risk, cost, or exposure. The test: did this violation, by itself, create real risk, cost, or exposure to the company, the public, or the crew — regardless of whether anyone got hurt or anything actually broke? If yes, it's Tier 2.	Negligent equipment damage with skipped procedure; operating outside qualifications; refusing PPE after correction; concealing damage or an incident; supervisor failure to enforce; retaliation-adjacent conduct.	Enters at Step 2.
Tier 3. Process	The daily disciplines that	Missed PPE; missed JHA	Enters at Step 1.

Compliance	prevent everything else. The test: did this violation weaken a safeguard or process step without creating risk, cost, or exposure on its own — something that only matters if something else also goes wrong? If yes, it's Tier 3.	or pre-task plan; missed equipment checklist; missed toolbox attendance; housekeeping after a request.	

Falsification of any safety record, inspection, timecard, or qualification document is treated outside the ordinary ladder: a single proven instance is grounds for termination regardless of tier.

5.5 Behavior Classification (Just Culture)

The tier sets the entry point. Before any Step 3 or Step 4 action, the review committee classifies the behavior. Same act, different intent, different response.

Classification	Meaning	Response
Human Error	An honest mistake by someone trying to do the right thing, often set up by a system, training, or tool gap.	Console the person. Fix the system. No discipline.
At-Risk Behavior	Drift from the rule because the risk was not seen, was rationalized, or had become normal on the crew. The most common finding.	Coach, document, retrain. The tier entry point applies. Repeat preventable events escalate per the rules in 5.6.
Reckless Behavior	Knew the rule, knew the risk, chose to ignore it.	Escalation above the entry point. Reckless Tier 1 conduct is grounds for termination.
No-Fault / System Failure	No employee behavior contribution: procedures were followed and the system still produced the outcome.	No discipline of any kind. The system is examined and fixed; the event is logged for trend analysis.

The substitution test: would three other employees with the same training, at the same skill level, in the same conditions, likely have made the same choice? If yes, the problem is the system and the fix is the system. If no, the classification above governs.

For Tier 1 violations, the Company may impose any step up to and including termination based on the totality of the circumstances, including the potential for harm, the vulnerability of the public or the crew, client and site requirements, and the employee's overall record. The tiers

describe the ordinary response; they do not limit the Company's discretion under Handbook Section 8.5.

5.6 The Four-Step Ladder

Step	Action	Approval Required
Step 1. Documented Coaching	The supervisor reports the event to the Corporate Safety Officer the same shift. The Corporate Safety Officer conducts and documents the coaching conversation with the employee, and logs it in the central safety log within 48 hours. Not a formal write-up. Documented coaching is conducted by the Corporate Safety Officer only; no one else delivers it.	Corporate Safety Officer
Step 2. Written Warning	Formal written warning, signed by the employee, filed in the personnel file and the central log. Retraining assigned within 14 days is paid time.	Review Committee
Step 3. Stand-Down (1 to 3 days, unpaid for non-exempt employees)	Removal from work. Documented re-orientation with Corporate Safety before return. A subsequent violation within 12 months results in termination. For exempt employees, unpaid suspension is structured in full workweek increments or as accrued PTO use, per wage and hour law.	Review Committee
Step 4. Termination	Separation after investigation. Final pay and separation requirements per state law.	Review Committee, with HR execution

Prior record. An employee's record includes all documented discipline and preventable incidents, including those documented before this program's effective date. The Review Committee considers the full record on every recommendation of Step 2 or higher. At adoption of this revision, Corporate Safety and Human Resources enter existing documented discipline and preventable incidents from the prior 12 months into the central safety log as opening history.

Repeat events. A second preventable Tier 1 or Tier 2 event within 12 months enters the ladder one step above the tier entry point. A third preventable event within 12 months is referred to the Review Committee for a termination decision, regardless of tier. Event counts are tracked in the central safety log.

Introductory period. During an employee's first 90 days of employment, the progressive ladder does not bind the Company. Any Tier 1 or Tier 2 event classified as At-Risk or Reckless Behavior during the introductory period is routed directly to the Review Committee as an employment suitability decision, with termination available at entry. Events classified No-Fault / System Failure or Human Error, stopping work in good faith, and honest reporting are never grounds for action under this paragraph, during the introductory period or at any other time.

Active Steps 1 through 3 reset after 12 months of violation-free work, tracked in the central safety log. Time spent in required retraining is paid for all employees.

5.7 The Review Committee

One committee reviews every proposed Step 3 and Step 4 action, every introductory period routing and third-event referral under Section 5.6, and every driving event escalation under the Driver Acceptability Standards: the Chief Executive Officer, the Vice President, the Corporate Safety Officer, and the Human Resources Manager, or their written designees. Field operations leadership is consulted on job impact before decisions are final but is not a required approver. No Step 3 or Step 4 action is issued without committee review, and no supervisor may promise or impose one on their own. Corporate Safety reviews every action above Step 1 before it is issued to keep classification and consequences consistent across all divisions and entities.

5.8 Supervisors Are Accountable for Enforcement

A supervisor who observes a violation and does not act has committed a Tier 2 violation. Enforcement is not optional and it is not personal. Supervisors document coaching conversations, correct hazards on the spot, and escalate what they cannot correct. Leadership backs supervisors who hold the line.

5.9 Driving Events

Driving and vehicle events are governed by the Driver Acceptability Standards and Disciplinary Matrix and the Fleet Management Program. Where a driving event is also a violation of the 7 Rules (for example, seatbelt not worn, handheld phone in motion, or operating impaired), the safety tier sets the minimum response and the review committee resolves both tracks in a single decision. One event, one committee, one outcome.

5.10 Employees Covered by a Collective Bargaining Agreement

No employees of Straight Arrow Traffic Control Inc. are currently covered by a collective bargaining agreement. This section is retained as the group framework and activates by skin reissue if that changes.

The safety rules in this manual, the 7 Rules, stop work authority, and the violation tiers apply identically to every employee, including employees covered by a collective bargaining

agreement. For CBA-covered employees, the procedure for imposing discipline, including notice, representation, and grievance rights, follows the applicable agreement. Nothing in any agreement limits the Company's authority to remove an employee from work immediately for a safety violation pending the contractual process. Where this chapter and a CBA procedure differ, the CBA procedure governs the process; the safety standard itself does not change.

Not applicable at issue.

5.11 The Central Safety Log

Every coaching, warning, stand-down, termination, incident, near miss, and stop work event is entered in the central safety log maintained by Corporate Safety within 48 hours. Corporate Safety keeps the log current. Monthly, Corporate Safety provides the log to the Review Committee with an analysis of trends and recommended actions to prevent what the log shows developing.

5.12 Equipment Damage

All damage to equipment, vehicles, tools, and property, whether owned, rented, client, or third party, is reported, investigated, and resolved under this section. The purpose is the same as the rest of this program: find and fix the system, hold knowing violations accountable, and never give anyone a reason to hide damage.

Reporting. All damage, however minor, is reported to the supervisor and the Corporate Safety Officer the same shift it occurs or is discovered (Chapter 8.1). A scratch reported is a repair; a scratch hidden is a falsification problem. Damaged equipment that could affect safe operation is taken out of service, tagged, and not returned until cleared. Damage involving a utility, the public, a client's property, or a regulator follows Chapter 8 in full.

Investigation. Damage events are investigated on Form 10A with a Form 10A-1 for each employee involved. The first question is always behavioral: were all applicable procedures followed? If yes, the event is No-Fault / System Failure: no discipline of any kind. The damage is logged, the system is examined, and corrective actions are assigned with named owners and due dates. If a procedure was not followed, the behavior is classified under this chapter: human error, at-risk behavior (coached by the Corporate Safety Officer, documented, retrained), or reckless conduct (tier assignment and the discipline ladder).

A violation of a 7 Rules requirement in a damage event (seatbelt, spotter, raised bed, lockout) is a Tier 1 matter regardless of the damage amount. Concealing damage, or falsifying an inspection, checklist, or record connected to it, is outside the ladder entirely: a single proven instance is a terminable offense, routed directly to the Review Committee.

Discipline keys to behavior, never to the repair bill. A $50,000 failure with every procedure followed is a No-Fault system event. A $200 mirror knocked off while backing without a spotter

is a 7 Rules violation. Repair costs are recorded in the central safety log for trend analysis only. The moment discipline follows dollars, small damage disappears underground and surfaces later as big damage.

Tracking. Every damage event is entered in the central safety log within 48 hours with unit, description, estimated cost, classification, and corrective actions. Repeat events on the same unit, crew, or cause are flagged in the monthly Review Committee report with recommended prevention actions. Vehicle events that are also DOT matters follow the Fleet Management Program: one event, one investigation, one committee.

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CHAPTER 6. STOP WORK AUTHORITY

This chapter expands the standard set in Chapter 5.3 into the working procedure.

6.1 The Authority

Every employee of Straight Arrow Traffic Control Inc., regardless of position, seniority, or trade, has the authority and the obligation to stop any work they reasonably believe presents a danger to any person, the public, or a utility. The authority extends to stopping the work of other crews and, on our sites, the work of subcontractors. No permission is needed. No justification beyond a good-faith concern is required. A stop work call made in good faith is never wrong, even when the concern turns out to be unfounded.

6.2 How Work Gets Stopped

- Say it plainly: STOP WORK. Address the person in the hazard first, the supervisor second.
- Make the area safe. Remove people from exposure. Do not attempt to correct an imminent hazard alone or without protection.
- Notify the supervisor immediately. The supervisor notifies Corporate Safety the same shift for any stop involving a life-critical hazard, a utility, the public, or a subcontractor.

6.3 Restart

Work resumes only when all three are true: the condition is corrected or controlled, the person who stopped the work or the supervisor confirms it is safe to proceed, and the crew is briefed on what changed. If the person who stopped the work and the supervisor disagree on whether it is safe to resume, the work stays stopped and the question goes to Corporate Safety. Corporate Safety's call is final.

6.4 Documentation

Every stop work event is entered in the central safety log within 48 hours: who stopped it, what the condition was, how it was corrected, and when work resumed. Stop work events are reviewed for system lessons, never for blame. Crews and individuals who make good stop work calls are recognized for them.

6.5 No Retaliation

Chapter 5.3 applies in full. Retaliation against any person for stopping work or raising a concern in good faith is a Tier 1 violation and grounds for termination of the retaliating employee, including supervisors.

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CHAPTER 7. PRE-TASK PLANNING

One form set is used group-wide; the forms are indexed in Appendix B.

7.1 The Daily Plan

The daily plan is executed on the Daily Safety Tailboard (Form 4-A), completed and signed by every crew member each shift, and the Job Safety Analysis (Form 4-B), completed per task and redone whenever the task, the site, or conditions change. The tailboard also carries the daily program checks: review of the Weekly Safety Report with the crew, verification that new subcontractor employees signed the Subcontractor Site Orientation before starting, operator card checks for equipment operators, and competent person card checks by task.

No task starts without a plan. Every crew completes a written Job Hazard Analysis / Pre-Task Plan (JHA/PTP) at the start of every shift, for every task, on the standard form. The plan is written at the work location, by the crew that will do the work, led by the foreman or the most senior person on the task. It covers, at minimum:

- The steps of the task, in order.
- The hazards of each step, including utilities, energy sources, traffic, weather, adjacent crews, and the public.
- The controls for each hazard, named specifically: which protective system, which barrier, which permit, which PPE.
- Who is assigned to each role, including competent persons, spotters, and flaggers where the work requires them.
- The manual handling on the task: the heaviest and most repetitive lift, the aid or method to be used, and who rotates (Chapter 17).
- Emergency information: nearest medical facility, muster point, and who calls 911.

7.2 The Tailboard

The plan is worthless if the crew has not heard it. The foreman briefs the full crew on the plan before work begins. Every crew member signs the JHA/PTP. Anyone who joins the crew mid-shift is briefed and signs before starting work. Questions at the tailboard are a strength: a crew member who does not understand the plan says so, and the plan is explained or fixed.

7.3 Changed Conditions

The plan matches the work or the work stops. When conditions change (different task, different location, weather, an unexpected utility, new equipment, a new crew member, or anything the

plan did not anticipate), work pauses and the plan is redone or amended before work continues. A plan written for the morning does not cover an afternoon that looks different.

7.4 Documentation and Quality

Completed JHA/PTP forms are retained per Chapter 9 and are reviewed by superintendents on their weekly inspections and by Corporate Safety on site visits. The standard is a real plan for the real work of that day. A pre-filled, copied, or generic form is not a plan; a form signed by people who were not briefed is falsification under Chapter 5.4, and both are treated accordingly.

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CHAPTER 8. INCIDENT INVESTIGATION AND REPORTING

Form 10A is the standard investigation record group-wide.

8.1 What Gets Reported, and When

Every employee reports the following to their supervisor immediately, and in no case later than the end of the shift in which it occurred. The supervisor reports to Corporate Safety the same shift.

- Any injury or illness, however minor. First aid cases included.
- Any near miss: an event that could have caused injury, damage, or a utility strike under slightly different circumstances.
- Any utility contact or damage, any equipment or property damage, and any vehicle event.
- Any fire, spill, or release.
- Any contact from a regulator, and any incident involving the public or a client's facilities.

Late reporting is a Tier 2 violation. Concealing an incident is treated at Step 3 minimum, and falsifying a report is single-instance terminable under Chapter 5.4. Reporting an incident honestly is never, by itself, the basis for discipline.

8.2 Immediate Response and Scene Preservation

- People first: care for the injured, remove others from exposure, and call 911 where warranted. First aid and medical services per Chapter 14.
- Make the scene safe, then leave it alone. After a serious incident, nothing is moved, altered, or cleaned up except to rescue, prevent further harm, or as directed by responders, until Corporate Safety releases the scene.
- Photograph conditions as found. Identify witnesses and separate them for statements while memory is fresh.

8.3 External Reporting

Corporate Safety makes all regulatory notifications. In California, any serious injury or illness, or any death, is reported to Cal/OSHA immediately and in no case more than 8 hours after the Company knows or should have known of it (T8 CCR 342). Utility damage notifications, environmental releases, DOT-reportable events, and client notifications follow the applicable module and contract. No employee makes a regulatory or media statement about an incident; inquiries go to Corporate Safety and leadership.

8.4 The Investigation

Every reportable event under 8.1 is investigated on Form 10A. Corporate Safety leads or oversees the investigation; the supervisor of the affected work participates. Investigations begin within 24 hours and are completed promptly, with serious incidents given priority over all other safety work. The investigation establishes the facts, the sequence, the direct causes, and the system causes: what about our planning, training, equipment, supervision, or procedures allowed this to happen.

Behavior found in the investigation is classified under Chapter 5.5 before any discipline is proposed. The investigation answers what happened and why. The review committee answers what follows from it.

8.5 Corrective Actions

Every investigation produces corrective actions with a named owner and a due date, entered in the central safety log and tracked to closure. Corrective actions that change a rule, a procedure, or a module trigger an update to this manual under the version control process, and a safety alert to affected crews where warranted. Any module touched by an incident investigation is reviewed immediately.

8.6 Post-Incident Testing and Claims

Post-incident drug and alcohol testing is governed by the Combined Drug and Alcohol Policy, including its DOT riders. Testing decisions follow that policy's criteria, never assumption or accusation. Injury claims, medical management, and return to work are handled under Chapter 24 and the claims protocol; supervisors report claims information to Corporate Safety and HR only.

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CHAPTER 9. RECORDKEEPING AND RECORDS ACCESS

Anchored to Cal/OSHA (T8 CCR 14300 series, 3204). 1020.

9.1 Principle

Records are how this program proves itself: to a regulator, to a carrier, to a court, and to ourselves. A record that does not exist, cannot be found, or was filled in after the fact is worse than no program at all. Every record required by this manual has an owner, a home, and a retention period. Falsification of any record is single-instance terminable under Chapter 5.4.

9.2 Injury and Illness Recordkeeping

- Corporate Safety maintains the OSHA 300 Log and 301 incident reports for Straight Arrow Traffic Control Inc.. Recordable cases are entered within 7 calendar days of learning of them. Recordability decisions are made by Corporate Safety, never by a supervisor in the field.
- The 300A annual summary is certified by entity executive leadership and posted at each establishment from February 1 through April 30, and submitted electronically where size and industry thresholds require it.
- Logs and summaries are retained 5 years and updated when case status changes.
- Privacy cases are handled per the regulation: the name comes off the log, the case stays on it.

9.3 Program Records and Retention

Record	Owner	Retention
JHA/PTP forms, tailboards, toolbox talks	Superintendent files to Corporate Safety	1 year minimum
Inspection records (site, facility, equipment)	Corporate Safety	1 year minimum
Training and orientation records, acknowledgments, certifications	Corporate Safety training matrix	3 years minimum, and for the duration of the certification
Incident investigations (Form 10A) and corrective actions	Corporate Safety, central safety log	5 years
Discipline records under Chapter 5	HR personnel file and central safety log	Per HR retention schedule
Employee exposure and medical records	HR / Corporate Safety, confidential	Duration of employment plus 30 years (T8 3204)
Permits (confined space, hot work, excavation, client permits)	Superintendent files to Corporate Safety	1 year, or per the governing standard

9.4 Employee Access

Any employee, former employee, or their designated representative may request their own exposure and medical records under T8 3204 and the injury log entries the regulation entitles them to see. Requests go to Corporate Safety or HR and are fulfilled within the regulatory timelines. Medical records are confidential and are released only as the regulation and the employee's authorization allow.

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CHAPTER 10. HAZARD COMMUNICATION

Anchored to Cal/OSHA (T8 CCR 5194). 1200.

10.1 Purpose and Scope

Employees have the right to know what chemicals they work with and around, what those chemicals can do to them, and how to protect themselves. This program covers every hazardous chemical used or stored by Straight Arrow Traffic Control Inc.: fuels, oils, solvents, adhesives, concrete and masonry products, compressed gases, paints and coatings, and shop chemicals. It applies on our sites, in our yards and shops, and in our vehicles.

10.2 Chemical Inventory and Safety Data Sheets

- Corporate Safety maintains the master chemical inventory for the entity. Superintendents and yard managers keep their location list current; no new chemical is brought into use until its SDS is on file and any needed controls are in place.
- An SDS for every chemical at a location is accessible to every employee on that location during every shift, without asking permission: in the site or shop SDS binder, or electronically where reliable access exists, with a backup when it does not.
- If an SDS is missing, the chemical is not used until it is obtained.

10.3 Labels

- Manufacturer containers keep their labels, legible and intact. A container with a damaged or missing label is taken out of service until relabeled.
- A compliant label includes six elements: product identifier, signal word (Danger or Warning), hazard statement(s), pictogram(s), precautionary statement(s), and the supplier's name, address, and phone number. A label missing any of these is treated the same as a damaged or missing label under this section.
- Secondary containers (spray bottles, fuel cans, small mix containers) are labeled with the product identity and hazard warnings. The only exception is a container used immediately and completely by the person who filled it, within the shift.
- Fuel and chemical transfer containers meet the applicable container standards. Food and drink containers are never used for chemicals. Ever.

10.4 Training

Every employee is trained at orientation and whenever a new hazard is introduced: how to read a label and an SDS, the physical and health hazards of the chemical categories in their work —

including simple asphyxiants and combustible dust where present, such as confined space atmospheres and silica-generating work — how to detect a release, the protective measures and PPE required, and where the inventory and SDS collection live. Training is in a language and manner the employee understands, and is documented per Chapter 9.

10.5 Non-Routine Tasks and Multi-Employer Sites

- Before a non-routine task involving chemicals (tank or equipment cleaning, demolition of coated or treated materials, unexpected containers found in an excavation), the supervisor and Corporate Safety review the hazards and controls at the pre-task plan. Unknown containers or suspect materials stop the work until identified.
- On multi-employer sites, we inform other employers of the hazardous chemicals our work exposes their people to, provide SDS access, and obtain the same from them. Their chemical hazards go into our crew's pre-task plan.
- On client-controlled sites, the client's hazard communication program applies alongside this chapter; the stricter provision governs.
- Corporate Safety verifies on rotation: SDS accessible without delay, labels intact on primary and secondary containers, non-routine task hazards reviewed before work starts, and training documented per Chapter 9.

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CHAPTER 11. PERSONAL PROTECTIVE EQUIPMENT

The entity PPE table and any FR/arc-rated requirements are set out in Appendix A and work modules.

11.1 Principle

PPE is the last line of defense, never the first. Hazards are eliminated, substituted, engineered out, or controlled by procedure before PPE is relied on. But the last line holds: where PPE is required, wearing it correctly is a condition of being on the work, and a missed-PPE violation enters the discipline ladder at Step 1 under Chapter 5.

11.2 Hazard Assessment

Corporate Safety certifies a written PPE hazard assessment for the entity's operations, by work type, reviewed annually and whenever the work changes. The assessment drives the entity PPE table in the skin. The daily JHA/PTP is the task-level assessment: it names the PPE for that day's work, including anything above the standard set.

11.3 Minimum Field Standard

On every jobsite and in every yard and shop work area, unless Appendix A or a work module sets more:

- Hard hat, ANSI Z89.1.
- Safety glasses, ANSI Z87.1. Face shield over them for cutting, grinding, chipping, and chemical splash.
- High-visibility apparel, Class 2 minimum; Class 3 for night work and where the traffic control module requires it.
- Safety-toe boots in serviceable condition, ASTM F2413.
- Gloves matched to the task: cut-rated for handling, chemical-rated for chemicals, leather for general work.
- Hearing protection in posted areas and around high-noise equipment. Respiratory, fall, FR, and arc-rated equipment per the applicable work module and the entity table.

11.4 Provision, Fit, and Care

- The Company provides required PPE at no cost to employees, in the sizes its people need. Prescription-compatible eye protection is accommodated.

- PPE is inspected by the wearer before each use. Damaged, expired, or contaminated PPE is removed from service and replaced; there is no discipline for asking for replacement gear, only for working without it.
- Fall protection, respirators, and other life-critical PPE are inspected, fitted, and maintained per their governing modules, including fit testing and medical evaluation where required.

11.5 Enforcement

Supervisors verify PPE at the tailboard and throughout the shift. Visitors and subcontractor personnel on our sites meet the same minimums or leave the work area.

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CHAPTER 12. HEAT ILLNESS PREVENTION

Anchored to Cal/OSHA (T8 CCR 3395 outdoor; T8 CCR 3396 indoor where applicable). The Fed OSHA base text carries the equivalent program with AZ addendum triggers.

12.1 Purpose

Heat kills workers in our climate and our trades every year, and it is entirely preventable. This chapter is the entity's written Heat Illness Prevention Plan. It is available at every worksite, and the supervisor running the work is responsible for executing it every hot day, without being asked.

12.2 Water

Fresh, pure, suitably cool drinking water is available at no cost, as close as practicable to the work, in quantities sufficient for at least one quart per employee per hour for the full shift. Supervisors encourage frequent drinking; nobody waits until they are thirsty. Water service is checked at the start of the shift and replenished before it runs low.

12.3 Shade

When the outdoor temperature exceeds 80 degrees, shade is up and available: enough for all employees on a rest or meal break to sit in full shade without crowding, as close as practicable to the work. Below 80 degrees, shade is provided on request. Employees who need a preventative cool-down rest take one, are monitored, and are never ordered back to work until symptoms are gone; a cool-down rest is paid time and lasts no less than 5 minutes in the shade.

12.4 Acclimatization

New employees, employees returning from time away, and everyone during a heat wave are at the highest risk. Supervisors closely observe new and newly assigned employees for their first 14 days of hot work, and all employees during a heat wave or the first hot spell of the season. Workload and pace are adjusted while bodies adapt. Being new is a risk factor, and the schedule respects it.

12.5 High-Heat Procedures (95 Degrees and Above)

- Pre-shift meeting covering the high-heat plan, water, symptoms, and the buddy system.
- Effective observation of every employee: a mandatory buddy system, supervisor observation of 20 or fewer employees, or regular communication with anyone working alone.

- Effective communication maintained with every employee (voice, radio, or observation; a phone only where reception is reliable).
- Reminders to drink water throughout the shift, and rest breaks taken in shade.

12.6 Emergency Response

- Every crew knows the signs: heavy sweating, cramps, headache, and fatigue mean heat exhaustion; confusion, staggering, hot dry skin, or collapse mean heat stroke, and heat stroke is a 911 call, immediately.
- A sick employee is never left alone and never sent home or to their vehicle unaccompanied. Move them to shade, cool them aggressively (water, wet cloth, airflow), and get medical help per the severity.
- Every site's emergency information (Chapter 7 pre-task plan) includes clear directions for responders to the work location, especially remote and right-of-way work.

12.7 Indoor Heat

Scope and Definition

This section applies to indoor places of employment: any space under a ceiling or overhead covering that restricts airflow, enclosed along its entire perimeter by walls, doors, windows, dividers, or other barriers that restrict airflow, whether open or closed. Shops, warehouses, enclosed structures, and covered spaces that meet this description are indoor for purposes of this section, regardless of how they're used. A covered structure that is not enclosed along its entire perimeter is not indoor; it follows the outdoor provisions in Sections 12.2 through 12.6 instead. Yard and shop managers determine which of their spaces meet this definition and document that determination.

The Two Triggers

Indoor heat illness prevention has two levels, and they are not the same obligation:

At 82 degrees or above, when employees are present, the baseline requirements apply: water, a cool-down area, effective emergency response, and training.

At 87 degrees or above, or at 82 degrees where employees wear clothing that restricts heat removal or work in a high-radiant-heat area, the full requirements apply: everything in the baseline, plus temperature and heat index monitoring, recordkeeping, the controls hierarchy in Part E, and written indoor heat illness prevention measures for that space.

> A space that only ever reaches the first threshold does not automatically require the second tier's controls or monitoring. A space that reaches the second threshold requires both.

Water and Cool-Down Areas

Fresh, pure, suitably cool drinking water is available at no cost, as close as practicable to the work, per the same standard as Section 12.2.

A cool-down area is maintained below 82 degrees, shielded from direct sunlight and radiant heat sources, sized for the number of employees who might use it at one time, and located close

enough to be practical. Employees who take a preventative cool-down rest are monitored and are never ordered back before symptoms resolve, per the same standard as Section 12.3.

Monitoring and Recordkeeping

Where a work area meets the 87-degree trigger (or the qualifying 82-degree conditions in Part B), the supervisor:

Measures and records temperature and heat index in that work area.

Identifies and evaluates other environmental risk factors for heat illness present in that space (radiant heat sources, humidity, air movement, clothing/PPE requirements).

Keeps those records available at the site.

Controls Hierarchy

Where the 87-degree trigger applies, controls are applied in this order:

Engineering controls first: reduce and maintain temperature and heat index below 87 degrees, or below 82 degrees where employees wear heat-restrictive clothing or work in a high-radiant-heat area. Fans, ventilation, insulation, spot cooling, and isolating process heat sources are typical measures.

Administrative controls, where engineering controls alone are not sufficient: adjusted work/rest schedules, rotation, and rescheduling heat-generating tasks.

Personal heat-protective equipment, only where the employer demonstrates that feasible engineering and administrative controls do not sufficiently minimize the risk, and only to the extent equipment is feasible for the task.

Written Indoor Heat Illness Prevention Measures

For each indoor space meeting the 87-degree trigger, the supervisor maintains a written record of: which controls from Part E are in place, who is responsible for implementing them, and how compliance is verified. This is reviewed and updated when conditions or the space itself change.

Acclimatization and Training

The acclimatization protections in Section 12.4 apply to employees newly assigned to hot indoor work the same way they apply to outdoor work: close observation for the first 14 days, and adjusted workload and pace while the body adapts.

Training under Section 12.8 includes, for employees who may work in indoor heat: how to identify whether a space is indoor under Part A, the two-trigger structure in Part B, the specific controls in place at their facility under Part E, and the vehicle/container exception in Part G.

12.8 Training

Every employee and supervisor is trained on this chapter before hot work, including risk factors, the Company's procedures, the importance of water and acclimatization, symptom recognition, and emergency response. Supervisors are additionally trained on their monitoring and response duties and on how weather triggers each procedure.

CHAPTER 13. EMERGENCY ACTION AND FIRE PROTECTION

Facility-specific plans and maps are set out in Appendix A.

13.1 Scope

This chapter covers emergencies at fixed facilities (offices, yards, shops) and on jobsites: fire, medical emergency, severe weather, earthquake, utility emergencies, and any event requiring evacuation. Site-specific emergency information for field work lives in the daily pre-task plan (Chapter 7); this chapter sets the standard that plan must meet.

13.2 Emergency Action Plan

- Every facility has a posted evacuation map, designated exit routes kept clear at all times, a muster point, and a way to account for everyone on the property, including visitors.
- Every jobsite tailboard establishes the same three things daily: how the alarm is raised, where people go, and who accounts for the crew and calls 911.
- Alarm and notification: any employee who discovers an emergency raises the alarm first by the fastest means, then acts. On multi-employer sites, our alarm reaches the other employers' crews and theirs reaches ours; the controlling contractor's system governs.
- After any evacuation, nobody re-enters until the incident commander or responding agency clears it. Headcount discrepancies are reported to responders immediately; employees do not re-enter to search.
- Corporate Safety designates a person by name and title responsible for maintaining this chapter's plan and answering employee questions about it, and a person by name and title at each facility responsible for maintaining equipment that controls ignition sources and fuel hazards (fueling stations, heat-producing equipment, flammable storage). Both are named in the facility's Appendix A package.

13.3 Utility Emergencies

A struck gas line, downed or damaged electrical line, or damaged pressurized main is treated as a life threat, not a repair problem. Evacuate upwind and uphill for gas, establish distance for electrical (assume energized, minimum 30 feet, more for high voltage), eliminate ignition sources, call 911 and the utility owner, and keep the public back. The crew protects people and the perimeter; the utility owner makes it safe. Detailed procedures are in the underground utilities and electrical work modules.

13.4 Severe Weather and Earthquake

- Lightning within 10 miles (flash-to-bang 30 seconds or less) suspends exposed elevated work, crane operations, and open-field work until 30 minutes after the last strike.
- High wind suspends crane, hoisting, and panel operations per the equipment manual and the lift plan. Rain that defeats excavation protection or traffic control visibility suspends that work under the governing module.
- Earthquake: drop, cover, hold on inside; in the open, move clear of structures, poles, and lines. After shaking stops, evacuate per the plan, account for everyone, and treat every utility as suspect until inspected.

13.5 Fire Prevention and Protection

- Fuels, flammables, and compressed gases are stored, separated, and secured per the applicable standards; ignition sources are controlled around them, and refueling is done engine-off with bonding where required.
- Hot work (welding, cutting, grinding near combustibles) is performed under the hot work module with a fire watch where required.
- Portable extinguishers are provided at facilities, on jobsites, in company vehicles per the fleet standard, and on equipment where the module requires them: mounted, charged, accessible, visually checked monthly, and serviced annually.
- Extinguishers are distributed so travel distance never exceeds 75 feet for Class A hazards (ordinary combustibles) or 50 feet for Class B hazards (flammable liquids); Class C areas follow whichever of those patterns fits the underlying A or B hazard. Extinguisher type is matched to the hazard present — a Class B-rated unit alone is not sufficient where ordinary combustibles are also present.
- Employees are trained at orientation on extinguisher use and its limit: small, contained, early-stage fires only, with an exit at your back. Anything more is an evacuation and a 911 call. Fighting the fire is never required.
- Oily rags, packaging, sawdust, and other combustible waste are collected in covered metal containers and removed from the work area at the end of each shift; accumulation is not allowed to build up around ignition sources, exits, or extinguisher locations.

13.6 Drills and Review

Facilities conduct an evacuation drill at least annually, documented with date and attendance. The plan is reviewed after every drill, every real activation, and any facility change, and the lessons go into the master via the version control process. Every employee is trained on this chapter's plan before their first assignment, and retrained whenever their role changes in a way that affects their emergency duties or the plan itself changes. This is separate from and in addition to the annual evacuation drill.

CHAPTER 14. FIRST AID AND MEDICAL SERVICES

Designated clinics and facility postings are set out in Appendix A.

14.1 Trained Personnel

Every crew and every facility has ready access to a person currently certified in first aid and CPR. For field crews, that person is on the crew: certifications are tracked in the training matrix, planned into crew assignments by dispatch and the superintendent, and verified at pre-mobilization. Remote and right-of-way work is staffed so that trained response does not depend on outside help arriving quickly.

14.2 Supplies

- First aid kits sized to the crew are on every jobsite, in every crew truck per the fleet standard, and at every facility: inspected and restocked monthly and after every use, protected from dust and moisture, and matched to the hazards of the work per the modules (burn care, eye wash, trauma dressings where the work warrants).
- Where employees may be exposed to injurious corrosive materials, plumbed or portable eyewash meeting the standard is available at the work area, inspected on schedule.
- AEDs installed at facilities are inspected monthly and their locations posted.

14.3 Getting Help

- Every pre-task plan and every facility posting identifies: emergency numbers, the address or coordinates of the work, driving directions for responders, and the nearest emergency room and designated occupational clinic.
- Life threat, altered consciousness, uncontrolled bleeding, suspected spine injury, chest pain, heat stroke: call 911. Do not drive the person. For injuries below that line, a supervisor arranges transport to the designated clinic; an injured employee does not drive themselves.
- The supervisor notifies Corporate Safety the same shift for every injury, however minor, per Chapter 8. First aid cases are logged even when no treatment beyond the kit is needed.

14.4 Bloodborne Pathogens

Employees designated as first aid responders and employees whose duties include cleanup of blood or bodily fluids are covered by the entity's bloodborne pathogens exposure control program: universal precautions, gloves and barriers in every kit, proper cleanup and disposal, hepatitis B vaccination offered per the standard, and immediate reporting and medical follow-

up for any exposure incident. Nobody cleans up blood bare-handed, and no exposure goes unreported.

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CHAPTER 15. FIT FOR DUTY, DRUG AND ALCOHOL, AND FATIGUE

The Combined Drug and Alcohol Policy is the single source of truth for all testing; this chapter does not duplicate it.

15.1 Fit for Duty

Rule 7 of the 7 Rules: show up ready to work, free of impairment from drugs, alcohol, or fatigue. Fitness for duty is a condition of every shift, and it covers prescription and over-the-counter medication: any employee taking a medication that can affect alertness, judgment, coordination, or reaction time discloses it to their supervisor before the shift. The conversation is about the effect, never the diagnosis; medical information stays confidential with HR. Work assignments are adjusted while the effect lasts, and disclosure is never, by itself, the basis for discipline.

15.2 Drug and Alcohol Policy

All drug and alcohol requirements, prohibitions, and testing (pre-employment, reasonable suspicion, post-incident, random, and return-to-duty, including DOT programs under 49 CFR Part 382 and any FRA or PHMSA riders that apply to the entity's work) are governed by the Combined Drug and Alcohol Policy. That policy is the single source of truth. Where this manual and that policy touch the same subject, that policy governs the testing process and this manual governs the safety consequence: working impaired is a Tier 1 violation under Chapter 5, and refusal to test is treated as the policy provides.

Supervisors are trained to recognize the signs of impairment and to act on them: an employee reasonably suspected of impairment is removed from work immediately, not sent to their vehicle and not left operating anything, and the reasonable suspicion process in the policy is followed the same shift.

15.3 Fatigue

Fatigue impairs like alcohol does, and it is managed like the hazard it is:

- Scheduling: work hours, night work, and consecutive days are planned with fatigue in mind. Hours-of-service rules govern covered drivers per the Fleet Management Program; extended shifts elsewhere get supervisor attention, not autopilot approval.
- Self-declaration: an employee too fatigued to work safely says so to their supervisor, before the shift or during it. A good-faith fatigue declaration is never disciplined; the response is an

assignment adjustment, rest, or a safe way home. Nobody drives home dangerously tired because they were afraid to say it.

- Night work: lighting, task rotation, and check-ins per the applicable module. Supervisors watch their crews for fatigue the same way they watch for heat illness.

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CHAPTER 16. HOUSEKEEPING AND WALKING-WORKING SURFACES

Slips, trips, and struck-by events are among this group's most frequent injuries; this chapter is a working control set, not a slogan.

16.1 The Standard

A clean site is a safe site, and it is also the public face of the Company. Housekeeping is part of the work, built into every task, every crew, every day. Clean as you go: debris, scrap, and packaging are removed as they are generated, not at the end of the week. The last hour of demobilization includes leaving the area clean.

16.2 Access and Walking Surfaces

- Walkways, stairs, ramps, and access routes are kept clear of materials, cords, hoses, tools, and mud buildup. A blocked exit route is corrected now, not noted for later.
- Cords and hoses crossing walkways are elevated, ramped, or routed around; crossing traffic areas, they are protected. Ground conditions (mud, ice, standing water, uneven backfill) are corrected, covered, or barricaded and lit.
- Holes and floor openings are covered per the fall protection module: secured, marked, and rated for the load, never a loose sheet of plywood.
- Work areas, stairs, and access routes have adequate lighting for the shift being worked; night work lighting per the applicable module.

16.3 Materials and Struck-By

- Materials are staged stable, stacked per manufacturer limits, banded or blocked against shifting, clear of edges, openings, and traffic lanes, and never within the buffer of a traffic control zone or the influence line of an excavation.
- Nails and screws in stripped lumber are pulled or bent flat before stacking. Rebar and other impalement hazards are capped or covered where any person could fall onto them.
- Tools and materials are secured against falling when work occurs overhead; barricades and toe boards protect the level below, and hard hat areas are enforced under it.

16.4 Responsibility

The foreman owns the housekeeping of the work area, the superintendent owns the site, and the yard or shop manager owns the facility. Housekeeping is checked on every weekly

inspection, and a housekeeping deficiency left standing after a request enters the ladder at Step 1 under Chapter 5.

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CHAPTER 17. MATERIAL HANDLING AND ERGONOMICS

Repetitive trauma and manual handling injuries are a leading claims driver for this group. The Ergonomics and Repetitive Motion Injury Prevention Program governs in full; this chapter states the field rules.

17.1 The Program

The Company maintains a written Ergonomics and Repetitive Motion Injury Prevention Program, effective October 15, 2026, covering every Hays Group entity. It sets management responsibility, worker involvement, worksite evaluation, controls, training, early reporting and medical management, records, and annual review, and it satisfies Title 8, Section 5110 for California work. Corporate Safety owns it. Where this chapter and the Program differ, the Program governs. Rigging and hoisting are governed by the Cranes and Rigging module; this chapter and the Program cover what people move by hand and the postures, repetition, and vibration of the work.

17.2 Mechanical Aids First

The first question on any lift is not how to lift it. It is whether a person should be lifting it at all. Excavator rigging, pipe slings and clamps, vault lid and trench plate lifters, pipe carts and rollers, hand trucks, dollies, hose carts and balancers, cable pullers, cone and drum racks, hoists, and jacks exist so that backs do not do machine work. Planning a task includes planning how material moves: to the work, at the work, and away from it. The Program lists the standard aids for each operation. Crews use what is available to them, the foreman records the aid or method on the JHA/PTP, and where the preferred aid is not on site the foreman selects another method under the Program's lifting guidelines and records it. Corporate Safety inventories equipment by crew and the Review Committee fills gaps on a phased plan.

17.3 Manual Lifting

- **Limits.** One person lifts no more than 50 pounds alone under good conditions, and less when the load is awkward, far from the body, lifted from the floor or above the shoulders, or lifted repeatedly. Fifty to 100 pounds is a team lift or mechanical. Over 100 pounds is mechanical, always. Pipe, vault lids, trench plates, shoring components, tires, and batteries above these limits are never lifted by hand. The limits are maximums, not targets.
- Size it up before you touch it: weight, path, footing, and where it lands. If the path is blocked, clear it first.
- Lift with the load close, back straight, legs driving, no twisting; turn with the feet. Set it down the same way.

- Team lift anything awkward, long, or heavier than one person handles comfortably, with one person calling the lift. Asking for a second set of hands is expected, never a knock.
- Where the site and delivery allow, materials are staged at working height, knee to shoulder, close to the point of use, so they are not lifted from the ground, carried over distance, or handled twice.
- Gloves matched to the material, and pinch points identified before the load moves: hands out of the crush zone when setting materials down.

17.4 Repetitive Trauma Prevention

- **Stretch and flex.** Crews do the five-minute routine in the Program as part of the morning tailboard, led by the foreman. A second round after lunch is recommended on heavy or repetitive work days.
- Rotate high-repetition and high-vibration tasks across the crew where the work and crew size allow: shoveling, hose handling, flagging, trowel and vibrator work, cone placement, repetitive hand tool work. Breaks and task variety are planning items, not favors.
- Set up work at the right height where possible: stands, benches, and staging reduce sustained stooping and overhead reaching. Long-handled and extension tools, ratcheting and powered tools, and kneeling pads are the standard for the tasks the Program names.
- Operators and drivers adjust suspension seats and mirrors to themselves, use three points of contact, and take scheduled breaks out of the cab on long shifts. Worn seats are replaced through the fleet maintenance system.
- Employees new to a physically demanding task, or returning from time off or restricted duty, are paired with an experienced employee and eased into the work for the first days.

17.5 Planning and Worker Involvement

- The JHA/PTP (Form 4-B) and the Daily Safety Tailboard (Form 4-A) carry an ergonomics line: the heaviest and most repetitive handling on the task, the aid or method to be used, and who rotates. It is completed with the crew, not for them.
- Any crew member may stop a lift or a task under Chapter 6 and ask for a different method or an aid. Discomfort or doubt is reason enough.
- Crew suggestions, discomfort reports, and evaluation findings go in the central safety log and into Corporate Safety's monthly report to the Review Committee (Chapter 5). Corporate Safety reports back to the crew on what was decided.

17.6 Worksite Evaluation

Corporate Safety, or a superintendent trained by Corporate Safety, evaluates a task for ergonomic risk using the Program checklist when a new task, tool, or operation starts; after any recordable or lost-time sprain, strain, or cumulative trauma injury, as part of the Form 10A investigation; after a discomfort report that meets the Program's criteria; when two or more employees in identical work have physician-diagnosed repetitive motion injuries within twelve months; and annually by operation during site inspections. The employees doing the task are

consulted and their input is recorded. Corrective actions are tracked to closure like any inspection finding.

17.7 Early Reporting

- Early reporting is the control that works. Aches, pain, numbness, tingling, swelling, stiffness, or loss of grip connected to work are reported to the supervisor the same day they are noticed, not when they become a claim. A discomfort report is not an injury claim.
- The supervisor records it on the Program's Discomfort Report, adjusts the task or rotates the employee that day, and sends the form to Corporate Safety and Human Resources before the end of the shift. Corporate Safety reviews it; a full evaluation follows under the criteria in the Program.
- Where symptoms persist or the employee requests it, evaluation at the designated clinic follows Chapter 14, and the event becomes an injury report under Chapter 8. Restrictions are managed under Chapter 24 with regular wages continued on transitional duty.
- Reporting a symptom is never disciplined. Discouraging, delaying, or talking an employee out of a report is a Chapter 5 violation. Supervisors do not diagnose and do not tell anyone to work through pain.

17.8 Training and Records

- Ergonomics is part of orientation under Chapter 23, with an annual refresher delivered through the existing safety meeting and tailboard schedule, task-specific training on assignment to new physical demands, and supervisor training on planning controls, leading stretch and flex, and taking a discomfort report. Delivered in English and Spanish and recorded in the training matrix with a signed acknowledgment.
- Evaluations, discomfort reports, training records, and the annual Program review are kept per Chapter 9 and the Program. Corporate Safety reviews the Program with executive leadership annually and after any cumulative trauma claim.

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CHAPTER 18. HAND AND POWER TOOLS

Powder-actuated tools, powered saws, and specialty equipment carry additional requirements in the applicable work modules.

18.1 The Right Tool, In Good Condition

Injuries with tools come from three places: the wrong tool, a damaged tool, or a defeated guard. All three are within the user's control, and all three are checked before use, every use. Cheater bars, modified tools, and homemade handles are not used. A tool used outside its design (a wrench as a hammer, a screwdriver as a chisel) is the wrong tool.

18.2 Inspection and Removal from Service

- The user inspects before each use: cords and plugs, guards, handles, bits and blades, hoses and fittings. Company tools get a documented periodic inspection per the shop program.
- A damaged or defective tool comes out of service now: tagged DO NOT USE and turned in for repair or destruction. Using a tool with a known defect is treated under Chapter 5 the same as any known-defect operation: Step 3 minimum.

18.3 Guards and Safety Devices

Guards stay on and functional. Removing, pinning, blocking, or otherwise defeating a guard, a trigger safety, or an interlock is removing a safety device: a Tier 1 violation under Chapter 5.4. A tool whose guard must come off for the task is the wrong tool for the task, and the work stops until the right one is on site.

18.4 Power and Environment

- Electric tools run on GFCI protection on construction sites, with cords rated for the service, protected from damage and water, and never carried or lowered by the cord.
- Pneumatic fittings are secured against disconnection (pins or clips plus whip checks on large lines); air is never used to clean clothing or skin.
- Fuel-powered tools are shut off to refuel and are not run in enclosed spaces without ventilation per the applicable module.
- Cutting, grinding, and chipping require the face shield over safety glasses per Chapter 11, hearing protection, and fire watch conditions per Chapter 13 where sparks reach combustibles.

CHAPTER 19. LADDERS

Fall protection above ladder work, scaffolds, and aerial lifts are governed by their own modules.

19.1 Is a Ladder the Right Answer

The first ladder decision is whether to use one at all. For work of any duration, at height, or requiring two hands and force, a scissor lift, boom lift, scaffold, or platform is usually the better and required answer. A ladder is for access and short-duration light work. If you cannot keep three points of contact and stay centered while doing the task, the task does not belong on a ladder.

19.2 Selection

- Duty rating matched to the user plus tools; Type IA or IAA for construction use.
  - Type IA ladders are rated for 300 lbs; Type IAA for 375 lbs. Verify the duty rating label matches the rated load before use, not just the ladder's general condition.
  - Maximum lengths: step ladder, 20 feet; two-section extension (wood), 60 feet; two-section extension (metal), 48 feet; three-section extension (metal), 60 feet; two-section extension (reinforced plastic), 72 feet. A ladder exceeding these lengths for its type is not used regardless of condition or rating.
  - Where 25 or more employees use a ladder at one location, or where two-way ladder traffic is expected, a double-cleat ladder is used, capped at 24 feet.
  - Ladders are never painted or coated with any opaque covering; a coating can hide cracks, splits, or corrosion. Identification or warning labels may be placed on one face of a side rail only.
- Fiberglass, and only fiberglass, anywhere near electrical work or where contact with any conductor is possible. Metal ladders are prohibited in those areas.
- The right length: an extension ladder extends at least 3 feet above the landing and is tied off or secured; a stepladder tall enough that the top two steps are never used, opened fully with spreaders locked, never leaned folded.

19.3 Setup and Use

- Inspected by a qualified person before each use: rails, rungs, feet, spreaders, ropes, and labels. A damaged ladder is tagged "Dangerous, Do Not Use," removed from service immediately, and destroyed or repaired by qualified means, never left where someone can grab it.

- On a two-section extension ladder, the sections overlap by at least: 3 feet for ladders up to 36 feet; 4 feet for ladders over 36 feet up to 48 feet; 5 feet for ladders over 48 feet up to 60 feet. A ladder without adequate overlap for its extended length is not used.
- Set on a firm, level base, feet secured against ice and mud, at 4 to 1 for extension ladders, in a cleared and, where exposed, barricaded area; doors it could be struck through are locked or guarded.
- Three points of contact, facing the ladder, belt buckle inside the rails. Tools go up on a hoist line or in a belt, never carried in the climbing hand.
- One person on a ladder at a time unless it is designed for two. Fall protection applies above the thresholds in the fall protection module, including on fixed ladders per that module.

19.4 Training and Verification

- Every employee who uses a ladder is trained before first use on: selecting the right ladder for the task (length or height needed, working load, duty rating, and how often it's used); erecting a ladder correctly (footing support, top support, securing, and angle of inclination); climbing and working position and points of contact; the factors that contribute to falls (haste, sudden movement, lack of attention, footwear, and physical condition); and prohibited uses (using a ladder for anything other than its designed purpose, climbing the cross-bracing, exceeding maximum lengths, and insufficient overlap on extension sections).
- Supervisors of employees who routinely use ladders receive this same training, not just the employees using the ladders.
- Corporate Safety verifies field application on its assessment rotation: correct ladder selected for the task, duty rating and length within limits, inspection current, setup angle and securing correct, and training on file for the crew present.

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CHAPTER 20. WORKPLACE VIOLENCE PREVENTION

This chapter summarizes the entity's standalone Workplace Violence Prevention Plan under California Labor Code 6401.9; the WVPP document governs in full.

20.1 Policy

Straight Arrow Traffic Control Inc. does not tolerate violence, threats, intimidation, or harassment on its worksites, in its facilities, or in its vehicles, whether from employees, subcontractors, clients, or the public. This applies to conduct in person, by phone, and online where it reaches the workplace. Weapons are prohibited on Company property and worksites except as the law requires the Company to allow.

20.2 What Gets Reported

Employees report every incident, threat, or credible concern to their supervisor, Corporate Safety, or HR, including the four types the law recognizes: violence by an outsider with criminal intent, by a client or member of the public, by a current or former employee, and by someone with a personal relationship to an employee. Public interaction is real exposure for our crews on roadways and rights-of-way: aggressive drivers, confrontations at closures, and threats at work areas are workplace violence incidents and are reported and logged the same as anything internal. Reports can be made without fear of retaliation, and no employee is disciplined for reporting in good faith or for leaving a situation they reasonably believed was dangerous.

20.3 Response and the Violent Incident Log

- Immediate danger: get to safety, call 911, then notify the supervisor. Nobody is expected to confront an aggressor over property or a traffic device.
- Every incident is investigated under the WVPP, and every workplace violence incident is entered in the violent incident log with the detail the statute requires, retained 5 years. Corrective actions (site changes, staffing, client escalation, law enforcement referral) are tracked to closure.
- Employee conduct found to violate this chapter is handled under Chapter 5 and the Employee Handbook; threats and violence enter the ladder at the top.

20.4 Training

Every employee is trained on the WVPP at orientation and annually: the plan, how to report, the hazards specific to their work including public interaction at traffic control and right-of-way locations, and how to respond. Training records per Chapter 9.

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CHAPTER 21. SHORT SERVICE EMPLOYEES

Client SSE programs (ISNetworld and contract exhibits) may set stricter ratios; the stricter rule governs per Chapter 1.

21.1 Who Is an SSE

A Short Service Employee is anyone with less than 6 months of service with the Company, and anyone with less than 6 months in a new craft, role, or entity, regardless of total experience. A 20-year operator new to our work is an SSE for our purposes: they know the machine, they do not yet know us. New employees are statistically at their highest risk of injury in their first months, and this chapter exists because of it.

21.2 The Orientation Gate

No SSE performs field work until orientation is complete: the condensed field handbook delivered and acknowledged, the 7 Rules signed for, entity and client credentials verified per the pre-mobilization requirements, and the training matrix items for the role completed. Orientation is a gate, never a formality, and dispatch does not assign an employee whose gate is open.

21.3 Mentoring and Identification

- Every SSE is assigned a mentor: an experienced crew member designated by the foreman, responsible for pairing with the SSE on tasks, checking understanding at the tailboard, and speaking up on their behalf.
- SSEs are visually identifiable on site per the entity standard (hard hat marking or equivalent) so every crew knows who is new. The marking is a signal for extra eyes, never a target; hazing of new employees is a conduct violation handled under the Handbook.
- Crew composition respects experience: supervisors plan crews so SSEs are distributed, not concentrated, and client SSE ratio limits are honored where they apply.

21.4 Graduation

SSE status ends when the time threshold passes and the foreman and Corporate Safety confirm the training matrix for the role is complete and performance in the field supports it. Concerns extend the mentoring period; a calendar date alone does not end it.

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CHAPTER 22. SUBCONTRACTOR SAFETY MANAGEMENT

Not carried: Straight Arrow Traffic Control Inc. does not engage subcontractors. If that changes, this chapter applies in full and activates by skin reissue. On sites controlled by another Hays Group company or client, that controlling contractor's subcontractor program governs the site, and Straight Arrow Traffic Control Inc. participates as a subcontractor under Chapter 1.

CHAPTER 23. TRAINING AND ORIENTATION

The role-based training matrix is maintained alongside this chapter and loads per entity.

23.1 The System

Training here is a system with a gate, a matrix, and a record, not a stack of certificates. The gate is orientation: nobody works in the field without it. The matrix defines what every role must hold, initially and on refresh. The record proves it, per Chapter 9, and pre-mobilization verification checks it before a crew ships. Pre-mobilization qualification (ISNetworld, RWP and eRailSafe, client credentials) and field orientation are distinct steps: the first proves the gate is satisfied, the second delivers the site and the life-critical subset to the person standing on it.

23.2 Orientation

- Every new hire, rehire, and inter-entity transfer completes entity orientation before field assignment: this manual's field layer (the condensed handbook), the 7 Rules with signed acknowledgment, the Employee Safety Acknowledgment, stop work authority, reporting duties, PPE issue, and the IIPP basics of Chapter 3.
- Orientation is delivered in a language and manner the employee understands, Spanish included where crews require it, with comprehension checked, not assumed.

23.3 The Training Matrix

The matrix maps every role to its required training: regulatory (per this manual and its work sections), certification (operator cards, ATSSA for flagging work, competent person designations, first aid/CPR coverage), client-required (RWP, eRailSafe, client orientations), and refreshers with their cadences. Corporate Safety owns the matrix, tracks expirations, and flags lapses to dispatch and supervisors before they become field problems. An expired requirement means no assignment to the affected work until it is current.

23.4 Delivery and Verification

- Training assigned as a condition of work is paid time, for every employee, always.
- Operating credentials require demonstration, not just attendance: operator cards and competent person designations are issued on evaluated performance per their programs.
- Toolbox talks (weekly minimum) and tailboards (daily) are the field refreshers that keep the formal training alive; both are documented with topic and attendance.
- Training effectiveness is checked in the field: inspections and investigations that find a knowledge gap trigger retraining and a matrix review, per the version control process.

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CHAPTER 24. RETURN TO WORK

The Return to Work Program document governs in full; this chapter states the entity's commitment and the field interface.

24.1 Philosophy

An injured employee is still our employee. The Company's Return to Work Program exists to keep people connected to work, income, and crew while they recover: transitional and modified duty is offered wherever medically appropriate work exists, matched to written restrictions, at no loss of dignity. Staying at work and returning early to real, useful, restriction-compliant tasks produces better medical outcomes than sitting at home, and the Company plans modified assignments the way it plans any other work.

24.2 How It Runs

- Medical care and claims initiation follow Chapter 14 and the claims protocol; the designated clinic is provided the essential functions of the job so restrictions come back specific, not generic.
- HR and Corporate Safety coordinate every restriction with the supervisor. A modified assignment honors the restrictions exactly: a supervisor never asks, hints, or allows an employee to work outside written restrictions, and an employee reports any task that conflicts with theirs. Violations of restrictions are treated as the safety issue they are.
- Modified duty is reviewed at every medical re-evaluation until full release. Communication with the recovering employee is regular and goes through HR and the supervisor; nobody disappears into a claim.
- Filing a claim or accepting modified duty is never retaliated against, period.

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CHAPTER 25. DRIVING AND FLEET SAFETY

The Fleet Management Program, the Driver Acceptability Standards and Disciplinary Matrix, and field procedures P-1 through P-3 are the single source of truth for fleet, DOT, and driver qualification matters; this chapter is the safety manual's interface to them.

25.1 The Rules Every Driver Follows

Rule 6 of the 7 Rules governs every Company vehicle and every piece of mobile equipment: seatbelts on, spotter when backing, phone down. In addition:

- Every occupant belted before the vehicle moves. No exceptions, no short trips.
- No handheld phone use in motion; hands-free minimized and never in complex driving. A call, text, or navigation entry can wait for a stopped, parked vehicle.
- Backing gets a spotter where one is available, and a walk-around when alone. Pull-through and first-move-forward parking are standard practice.
- Speed and following distance matched to conditions, loads secured per the applicable module before the vehicle moves, and impaired or dangerously fatigued driving prohibited under Chapter 15.
- Journey management for long hauls and remote work: route, fuel, rest, and check-in planned before departure per the fleet procedures.

25.2 Authority and Qualification

The Fleet Manager is the authority for vehicle assignment, maintenance, DOT compliance, telematics, and driver qualification under the Fleet Management Program. Only authorized, qualified drivers operate Company vehicles; CDL, medical card, and DOT requirements are tracked under that program, and hours-of-service rules govern covered drivers. Vehicle defects are reported per the fleet inspection procedures, and a vehicle with a safety defect does not roll.

25.3 Events

Every vehicle event (collision, citation, telematics escalation, damage) is reported the same shift under Chapter 8 and handled under the Driver Acceptability Standards and Disciplinary Matrix. Where an event is also a 7 Rules violation, Chapter 5.9 applies: one event, one committee, one outcome.

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APPENDIX A. ENTITY INFORMATION AND DESIGNATED PERSONS

STRAIGHT ARROW TRAFFIC CONTROL

A1. Entity Identity

Field	Entry
Legal name	Straight Arrow Traffic Control Inc.
Contractor license(s)	CA CSLB #1060624
States of operation	California

A2. Named Persons

Role	Name	Function
Chief Executive Officer	Kirby Hays	Review Committee
Vice President	Karun Mani	Review Committee
Corporate Safety Officer / IIPP Administrator	Sergio Robles	Review Committee; program administration
HR Manager	Desiree Tapia	Review Committee; discipline execution
Field Operations	Jerry Neuman	Advisory to Committee on field impact
Fleet Manager	Derek Alonso	Vehicle, DOT, and driver qualification authority

Entity Role	Name
Entity Lead	Karun Mani (GM position open; reassign this row when filled)
Dispatcher	Bryan Alvarez

Designated competent persons by discipline, first aid/CPR roster, and operator card holders are maintained in the training matrix by Corporate Safety. To confirm any designation, contact Corporate Safety.

A3. Facilities

Facility	Address
Riverside office/yard	4181 Latham Street, Riverside, CA 92501
Yucaipa yard	32342 Dunlap Blvd, Yucaipa, CA 92399
Visalia yard	2500 E Valley Oaks Dr, Visalia, CA 93292
Hesperia yard	9481 Mariposa Rd, Hesperia, CA 92344

A4. Chapter Inserts and Switches

Insert	Setting
Ch 5.10 CBA insert	OFF
Ch 22 Subcontractor Management	OFF
Rail worker protection (RR-01)	CONDITIONAL: activated per job for rail ROW setups, with the pre-mobilization briefing
Certification standard	ATSSA: Flagger for all flaggers, TCT for leads, TCS for closure design/modification, tracked in the training matrix

A5. Entity PPE Table (additions to the Chapter 11 minimum)

Work	Additional PPE
All traffic control work	Class 2 minimum; Class 3 at night and per TC-01
Device handling	Cut/abrasion gloves
Rail ROW setups	Per RR-01

A6. Work Sections in This Manual

A7. Medical and Posting Information

Posting Item	Entry
Designated occupational clinic(s)	Riverside: Concentra Urgent Care, 1595 Spruce St Suite 150, Riverside, CA 92507. Yucaipa: Concentra Urgent Care, 1375 Camino Real Ste 130, San Bernardino, CA 92408. Visalia: Palm Occupational Medicine, 235 E Noble Ave, Visalia, CA 93277. Hesperia: Meridian Urgent Care and Occupational Health, 12821 Main St #140, Hesperia, CA 92345
Nearest emergency room (per facility)	Riverside: Riverside Community Hospital, 4445 Magnolia Ave, Riverside, CA 92501. Yucaipa: Redlands Community Hospital ER, 350 Terracina Blvd, Redlands, CA 92373. Visalia: Kaweah Health ER, 400 W Mineral King Ave, Visalia, CA 93291. Hesperia: Desert Valley Hospital, 16850 Bear Valley Rd, Victorville, CA 92395
Cal/OSHA / ADOSH reporting contact	Corporate Safety Officer: Sergio Robles, 626-366-2912
Jobsite posting kit	Per the Company portable posting kit program, entity-specific

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PART II. WORK MODULES

MODULE TC-01. TEMPORARY TRAFFIC CONTROL AND FLAGGING

Applies to all work of that kind performed under this manual. Crews exposed to traffic without running the closure follow the Working Near Live Traffic module.

1. Scope and Governing Standards

This module governs temporary traffic control: closures, detours, flagging operations, and device deployment on residential streets, commercial roads, and highways. Work conforms to the California MUTCD, Caltrans standard plans and special provisions where Caltrans has jurisdiction, the approved traffic control plan or permit for the job, and the client's requirements. The approved plan is on site during the operation. Where documents conflict, the stricter requirement governs, and deviations from an approved plan are made only with the authority that approved it.

Rule 5 of the 7 Rules applies to every person in this work: live traffic kills. A flagger leaving a station unprotected, or any employee stepping into a live lane outside established control, is a Tier 1 violation under Chapter 5.

2. The Temporary Traffic Control Zone

- Every closure is built as a complete zone: advance warning signs, transition taper, buffer space, work space, and termination, with device types, spacing, and taper lengths per the approved plan for the speed and road type.
- The buffer space is sacred: it is empty. No workers, no equipment, no material staged in the buffer. The buffer is the room a breaching vehicle needs to stop before it reaches people.
- Setup is performed in the direction of travel, advance warning first, so approaching drivers are warned before they meet the taper. Removal is performed in reverse order, termination area first, so warning remains while devices come out. Workers placing and retrieving devices face traffic wherever the operation allows and are shielded by the setup vehicle sequence in the plan.
- Night operations use retroreflective devices in serviceable condition, illuminated flagger stations, lighting for the work space that does not blind drivers, and Class 3 apparel. Device retroreflectivity is inspected on setup; failed devices are swapped, not deployed.
- Pedestrian and ADA paths are maintained or detoured per the plan: continuous, protected, and usable by a person with a disability, not an unmarked gap between cones.

3. Flagging Operations

- Flaggers hold a current ATSSA Flagger certification, carried on person. ATSSA is the Company certification standard for all flagging work, at every entity. Where a client, agency, or permit requires an additional or specific course, that requirement is met in addition to ATSSA, never in place of it.
- The flagger station is positioned per the plan: visible to approaching traffic at the stopping sight distance for the posted speed, ahead of the work space, with an identified escape route the flagger keeps open at all times. Flaggers never stand in the closed lane's shadow assuming protection, never turn their backs to live traffic, and never leave the station until relieved or the operation is suspended.
- The STOP/SLOW paddle is the standard control device, illuminated or retroreflective at night. Flag use is limited to emergencies and spot situations the MUTCD allows.
- Paired flaggers coordinate continuously by radio or unmistakable visual signal; one flagger releases traffic only on the other's confirmation. Pilot car operations follow the approved plan and the client's rules.
- Distraction is disqualifying: no phones, no earbuds, no conversations facing away from traffic while on station. A distracted flagger is removed from the station immediately.

4. Protection Vehicles and Devices

- Truck mounted attenuators are deployed where the plan requires them, positioned with the specified roll-ahead distance, transmission and brakes set per the manufacturer. The TMA operator's exposure is managed per the plan: belted in the cab or out of the vehicle in a protected location, never standing beside it.
- Arrow boards and changeable message signs are placed, aimed, and dimmed per the plan and the MUTCD; a wrong or stale message is worse than none and is corrected before the closure opens.
- Work vehicles enter and exit the closure at designated points, at closure speed, with spotters where the plan or congestion requires. Private vehicles do not park inside the closure.

5. Intrusions and Emergencies

- Every crew member on a closure knows the escape route from their position before the closure opens; it is part of the tailboard.
- On any intrusion or breach: warn by the fastest means, clear personnel, let the vehicle go. Devices and equipment are replaceable. Intrusions, near misses, and device strikes are reported the same shift and investigated on Form 10A.
- Weather, smoke, or visibility that defeats the closure's warning distances suspends the operation. The crew lead has stop authority and uses it; a closure that cannot be seen is not a closure.

6. Training and Certification

- Flaggers: current ATSSA Flagger certification before first assignment to a station, renewed before expiration per the certifying cycle. Certification is tracked in the training matrix and verified at pre-mobilization; an expired card means no station assignment until renewed.
- Lead technicians: ATSSA Traffic Control Technician (TCT). Supervisors responsible for closure design or field modification: ATSSA Traffic Control Supervisor (TCS). Where a client or contract requires these, they are verified before mobilization.
- Rail corridor setups follow Module RR-01, including the pre-mobilization briefing, in addition to this module.
- Every crew member on a closure, certified or not, is trained on this module at orientation and briefed on the specific plan at the tailboard.

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MODULE TC-02. WORKING NEAR LIVE TRAFFIC

For every crew exposed to live traffic without running the closure: locating, inspection, survey, utility work on shoulders, short-duration stops. TC-01 governs entities providing traffic control; this module governs exposure.

1. Rule 5 Applies to You

Live traffic kills the people who were just there for a minute. Rule 5 of the 7 Rules applies to every person on foot near a live lane: nobody steps into a live lane, ever, outside established control. Short-duration and mobile operations still require the protection the CA MUTCD prescribes for them; quick does not mean exempt.

2. Position and Protection

- Park the vehicle as protection: upwind of the work between traffic and the crew where practical, wheels turned so a struck vehicle deflects away from the work, lights and beacon on. Exit the vehicle away from traffic and work off the traffic side only when the task leaves no choice and the exposure is briefed.
- Class 2 high-visibility apparel minimum, Class 3 at night and on high-speed facilities. Hi-vis is worn fastened and outermost.
- Face traffic whenever the task allows; when the task forces your back to traffic, someone else watches for you. Nobody works alone with their back to live lanes.
- Escape route identified before starting: where you go when a vehicle leaves the roadway. It is part of the two-minute tailboard even for a ten-minute stop.

3. When the Task Outgrows the Stop

- If the work requires occupying a shoulder beyond a brief stop, entering a lane, or diverting pedestrians, it requires devices and a setup per the MUTCD: cones, signs, or a TC-01 closure by a qualified crew. Escalating protection is a scheduling call, never a personal risk decision by the person exposed.
- Distraction rules mirror TC-01: no phones or earbuds while exposed, and weather or visibility that defeats driver reaction distance suspends the exposure.

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Straight Arrow Traffic Control Inc.

ROADWAY WORKER PROTECTION AND ON-TRACK SAFETY

Applies to any employee whose duties place them on or near railroad property. Based on 49 CFR Part 214 Subpart C and host railroad rules.

1. Scope and the Absolute Rule

This module governs all work on or near railroad property: track work, culverts and bridges, utility crossings, subsurface work in rail corridors, and traffic control or support setup inside railroad right of way. The host railroad's rules (Union Pacific, BNSF, or other operators) govern on their property and are incorporated by reference; where this module and the railroad's rules differ, the stricter applies.

The absolute rule is Rule 5 of the 7 Rules: no employee fouls a track until on-track safety is established and the job briefing is complete. Fouling a track means being on the track or close enough to it to be struck by a train or on-track equipment, and it includes tools, equipment, and material, not just people. Fouling a track without established on-track safety is a Tier 1 violation under Chapter 5.

2. Qualification Before Entry

- No employee enters railroad right of way without current roadway worker protection training, the host railroad's contractor orientation and badging (eRailSafe or equivalent where required), and any site-specific qualification the railroad requires. No current card, no entry. There are no exceptions for short tasks, deliveries, or visits.
- Crews that work railroad property infrequently receive, in addition to current training, a pre-mobilization briefing from Corporate Safety before each assignment. Infrequent work is the highest-risk case: familiarity cannot be assumed, so it is rebuilt before every entry.
- The supervisor verifies and documents every crew member's qualification in the pre-task plan before mobilization. An unqualified worker found on railroad property stops the work.

3. On-Track Safety Methods

Every task that fouls a track is protected by one of the following, established with the railroad before work begins and named in the job briefing:

- Working limits: exclusive occupancy of a defined track segment, established through the railroad (foul time, track and time, or the railroad's equivalent). No train enters the limits while they are in effect. This is the preferred method for our work.

- Train approach warning: a qualified watchman or lookout dedicated solely to detecting approaching trains and warning the crew in time for everyone to clear to a predetermined place of safety. Used only where working limits are not available and the railroad's rules permit it.
- Inaccessible track: the track is physically inaccessible to trains through switches lined and locked, derails, or disconnects, per the railroad's procedures.

Individual train detection is not an authorized method for our employees. If the railroad proposes it, the work is re-planned under working limits or train approach warning.

4. The Job Briefing

Before any employee fouls a track, the roadway worker in charge conducts a job briefing that covers: the on-track safety method in effect and its limits, tracks affected and adjacent live tracks, expected train and equipment movements, the predetermined place of safety and the clearing route to it, communication and warning signals, and the time the protection expires. Every employee acknowledges the briefing before fouling. The briefing is repeated whenever conditions change, protection changes, the crew changes, or work moves to a different location. No briefing, no fouling.

5. The Watchman/Lookout

- Watchman duty is a dedicated assignment, identical in principle to the dedicated spotter in the utility module: the watchman does nothing but watch for trains and warn the crew. No tools, no phone, no other tasks. A watchman doing anything else is not a watchman, and the crew is unprotected.
- Warning is given early enough for every worker, with tools and equipment, to be clear of the track and in the place of safety at least 15 seconds before a train moving at maximum authorized speed arrives, or the longer time the railroad requires.
- Watchmen are assigned by name at the briefing, positioned for sight distance in both directions, and relieved for breaks by a qualified replacement with a handoff briefing. If the watchman loses sight lines or communication, everyone clears the track until protection is re-established.

6. Adjacent Tracks, Equipment, and Clearances

- Protection on one track protects that track only. Adjacent live tracks are treated as live: no person, tool, or equipment fouls an adjacent track outside the established protection.
- Cranes, excavators, and any boomed equipment working near track operate under the Cranes and Rigging module with railroad-approved clearances and, where required, a railroad flagman or employee-in-charge present. Swing radius and boom travel never foul a protected or live track without explicit protection.
- Hi-rail and on-track equipment operate under the railroad's rules and the operator qualification requirements of the Earthmoving module.

7. If a Train Approaches or Protection Fails

- On any warning, uncertainty, or loss of protection: clear the track immediately to the predetermined place of safety, take tools if it is instant, leave them if it is not, and account for every person.
- Work does not resume until the roadway worker in charge confirms protection and re-briefs the crew.
- Any near miss with a train or on-track equipment, any protection failure, and any unauthorized fouling is reported the same shift and investigated on Form 10A. The railroad's reporting requirements are followed in parallel.

8. Training and Verification

- Annual roadway worker protection training for every employee assigned to railroad work, plus the host railroad's requirements, with records maintained per Chapter 9 and available at the jobsite.
- Drug and alcohol requirements for railroad work, including FRA Part 219 where applicable, are governed by the Combined Drug and Alcohol Policy.
- Corporate Safety verifies field application on its assessment rotation: briefing documented, method in effect matches the briefing, watchman dedicated, place of safety real and reachable.

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MODULE IH-01. NOISE AND HEARING CONSERVATION

The hearing conservation program. Anchored to 29 CFR 1926.52/1910.95 and T8 CCR 5095 series. Replaces the legacy Noise Exposure Program chapters.

1. The Standard

- At or above an 8-hour average of 85 dBA, the hearing conservation program applies: protection provided, training delivered, and audiometric testing offered per the standard. A working test: if you must raise your voice to be understood at arm's length, protection goes in.
- Posted high-noise areas and designated high-noise equipment (impact tools, milling, pile driving, vacuum blowers, grinding, saws, shop air tools) require protection every time, full stop.
- Dual protection (plugs plus muffs) for the loudest operations: impact pile driving, extended jackhammer work, and any operation so designated by Corporate Safety.

2. Program Elements

- Protection is provided at no cost in at least two forms; fit and use are taught, not assumed, and protectors are matched to the exposure so speech and alarms remain audible.
- Audiometric testing: baseline within the standard's window for covered employees and annual tests thereafter, coordinated confidentially by HR; standard threshold shifts trigger refit, retraining, and follow-up per the standard.
- Buy quiet and keep quiet: equipment purchases consider noise, mufflers and enclosures are maintained, and a missing muffler is an equipment defect, not a personality trait.
- Training annually for covered employees: effects of noise, purpose and use of protectors, and the audiometric program. Documented per Chapter 9.

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MODULE EL-01. ELECTRICAL SAFETY AWARENESS

For unqualified workers: everyone who works near electricity without being qualified to work on it. Replaces the legacy Electrical Safety Awareness chapters. Qualified electrical work is governed by EL-05.

1. The Line You Do Not Cross

Unqualified workers never work on, open, or reach into energized electrical equipment. Panels stay closed, covers stay on, and anything electrical that is broken, smoking, buzzing, or wet gets distance and a report, not a look inside.

2. Overhead Lines

- Every overhead line is energized until the utility confirms otherwise in writing. Minimum approach for unqualified workers and equipment: 10 feet up to 50kV, more for higher voltages per the applicable table, and the table distances are airgap to any part of the machine, load, or tool.
- Equipment working near lines gets a dedicated spotter with no other duties, marked travel paths, and where the utility provides it, cover-up or de-energization arranged before the work. Booms, dumps (TR-02), ladders, and scaffold components are the repeat killers near lines.
- A machine that contacts a line: operator stays on the machine unless fire forces a jump-and-shuffle exit; everyone else stays back at least 35 feet and nobody touches the machine. 911 and the utility, immediately.

3. Cords, Tools, and Temporary Power

- GFCI protection for cord-connected tools on construction sites, cords rated and undamaged (no tape repairs), protected from crush and water, and plugs with grounding pins intact. Damaged means out of service per Chapter 18.
- Temporary power is installed and modified by qualified persons only; unqualified workers do not reset breakers on equipment circuits without knowing why they tripped.

4. Underground

- Buried electrical follows HC-02 in full: located, potholed, and treated as live. A damaged underground electrical line is a Chapter 13 utility emergency.

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MODULE TR-01. DOT / FMCSA FLEET COMPLIANCE POINTER

Pointer module: the Fleet Management Program is the single source of truth for all DOT and FMCSA matters. This module tells every entity where those obligations live and who owns them; it duplicates nothing.

1. What Lives in the Fleet Program

- Driver qualification files, CDL and medical certificate tracking, and the driver roster: owned by the Fleet Manager.
- Hours of service, ELD administration, and exemption determinations.
- Vehicle inspection program: pre-trip and post-trip DVIR requirements, periodic inspections, and out-of-service criteria. A written-up safety defect parks the vehicle per Chapter 25.
- DOT drug and alcohol program under 49 CFR Part 382, administered through the Combined Drug and Alcohol Policy, including post-accident testing decision criteria.
- CSA scores, roadside inspection results, and DataQ challenges.

2. What This Manual Adds

- The safety consequence layer: Rule 6, Chapter 25 driving rules, Chapter 15 fitness and fatigue, and the Chapter 5.9 one-event-one-committee rule for events that are both DOT matters and safety violations.
- Same-shift reporting of every roadside inspection, citation, collision, and out-of-service order to the Fleet Manager and Corporate Safety per Chapter 8.

3. Who Is Covered

- Every driver of a CMV as defined by the regulations, at every entity that operates one, per the Fleet Program's applicability determinations. Whether a vehicle or driver is DOT-covered is the Fleet Manager's call, made in writing, not a foreman's guess.

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